

An Overview of Software Translation

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When we write software, the computer cannot understand it directly. We need translators. There are two main types of translators: compilers and interpreters. Compilers translate the entire program at once.

This phase is critical because it simplifies the subsequent syntax analysis phase. If there are any illegal characters, the lexical analyzer will flag them immediately and halt the compilation process.

Interpreters, on the other hand, translate the program line by line. Both have their pros and cons, but compilers generally produce faster executables.